

Pea and lemon risotto

2 chicken stock cubes

Olive oil

1 brown onion, chopped finely

1 clove garlic, crushed

1 cup arborio rice

1 cup (250 ml) white wine (cask is fine)

Zest and juice of 1 lemon

1 cup (120 g) frozen peas, as a minimum

$\frac{3}{4}$ cup (60 g) grated parmesan

Salt and pepper

Boil the kettle and dissolve two stock cubes in 1.5 litres of boiling water. Heat oil in a saucepan over medium heat. Fry onion and garlic until onion is translucent. Add arborio rice and stir to coat in the oil, then stir occasionally until the edges of the rice start to become translucent. Add wine and cook, stirring, until it soaks into rice. Stir in lemon zest, then gradually add stock to rice – 1 ladle at a time, waiting for the liquid to absorb before adding another ladle. (Stirring will break the gluten and result in a creamier risotto; for a firmer result, gently stir and agitate the pan.) The whole process should take about 15 minutes. When you have 1–2 ladles of stock left and the rice is al dente, add lemon juice and peas, followed by the remaining stock, completing the moisture-absorbing process. Stir in parmesan and season to taste.

Serves 4. Cost per serve: \$3.75